

TOPIC 2: Writing: Report Writing

A report is spoken or written account of an event or happening that has taken place. It may be an event that has been heard, seen or done or studied. It is always a narrative based on an actual experiences of the reporter and very often requires record keeping to enable the writer to give actual figures and dates.

Types of Report

Private/informal report

This is the type of reports you narrate to your parents, friends or classmates of an incident that happened to you or you witnessed. It is supposed to be a direct personal experience of the writer.

Official/formal report

It is one that is presented as a formal document giving details of an event that occurred like a robbery incident, an accident, the proceedings of a meeting, a petition, a report of an excursion, research report of an experiment carried out etc.

Guidelines for report writing

Pay attention to details and be accurate.

Note the sequence of events. It is important to report precisely which events led to another and what action caused what result.

Take into consideration the purpose for which you are writing the report. A police report is different from a report to your classmates.

The method of presenting requires short and clear sentences with detailed information like, date, time of event, people present, cause, time it ended, effort made to stop or enhance the incident etc. explain in paragraphs giving only the essential facts which will present a true picture of what happened.